

DEVELOPER GUIDE · V0.11.0

# Golden Thread

Persistent memory across Claude Code sessions —  
install, operate, verify, and maintain the vault.

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# 1. The core idea

Claude's context window resets after every session. Golden Thread moves what you learn *out of the session* and into a structured vault on disk — before the session ends. The vault is an Obsidian folder tracked by git. The right slice of it is loaded at the start of every session.

## The promotion ladder

Every fact lives at the **narrowest scope that is honest** and is promoted upward only when a second project proves it general.

```
session conversation
↓ /gt:gt-work
Projects/<slug>/memory/*.md ← this project, this detail
↓ /gt:gt-promote
research.md · decisions.md ← settled findings and choices
↓ /gt:gt-promote
Knowledge/ ← true for several projects
↓ /gt:gt-promote
global-memory/ ← true in every session, everywhere
↓ /gt:gt-promote (with hook wiring)
core-rules/ ← enforced via hooks, not merely stored
```

Facts move **up** as they prove general. They never move back down. Retiring a fact sets `status: stale` and records what superseded it — the file stays on disk.

## The Core-rule tier

Above `global-memory/` sits the Core-rule tier. These are rules enforced via hooks wired into `~/.claude/settings.json` ( `UserPromptSubmit` + `Stop` hooks) — they are re-asserted every session, not just stored as files. `/gt:gt-init` installs these hooks automatically.

### STORED ≠ ENFORCED

A rule in `core-rules/` with no wired hook is inert — it looks correct and does nothing.

`/gt:gt-lint` reports this as `core-unenforced`. Treat it as a real defect; never suppress it.

## Loading is lazy, by design

`/gt:gt-open` reads the project's core docs and then reads `memory/MEMORY.md` only — one line per file. Memory files load on demand. A project with 70 notes costs ~80 lines to open instead of ~2,000. The one-line description in `MEMORY.md` is the entire basis for deciding whether a file is worth loading.

### THE DISCIPLINE

Promote a fact only when a **second project** proves it general. When in doubt, file it narrow — promotion is cheap, demotion isn't.

## 2. Installation

Requirements: Python 3.8+, Claude Code installed and running.

### Option A — Clone from GitHub

```
git clone git@github.com:shaven/golden-thread.git
cd golden-thread/golden-thread-plugin
bash install.sh
```

### Option B — Install from zip

```
unzip golden-thread-plugin.zip
cd golden-thread-plugin
bash install.sh
```

#### IMPORTANT

Restart Claude Code after install. The `/gt:` skills register at startup only and will not appear until you do.

### What the installer does

**gt** — memory, projects, session workflow, enforcement hooks — is installed into Claude Code's plugin cache, together with each **module** that is on.

### MODULES

A module is an optional plugin in the same marketplace, versioned with gt and declared by a `module.json`. 0.15.0 ships six:

- **wiki** ( `gt-wiki` , on) — knowledge base with immutable sources
- **demo** ( `gt-demo` , on) — the guided tour
- **watch** ( `gt-watch` , on) — upstream repo watch and its session-start report
- **report-card** ( `gt-report-card` , on) — the session report card and close-out question; hooks only, no command

- **flow** ( `gt-flow` , on) — offline HTML view of the event stream
- **farm** ( `gt-farm` , off for a fresh install, on for upgraders) — work packets for an external AI

Choose with `bash install.sh --list-modules` , `--without <name>` and `--with <name>` ; the choice is remembered. A module that is off leaves nothing behind, and its hooks are wired only while it is on.

```
~/.claude/plugins/cache/golden-thread-plugin/gt/0.15.0/  
  .claude-plugin/  ← plugin metadata  
  hooks/          ← enforcement hook scripts  
  scripts/        ← vault_init.py, gt_lint.py, gt_settings.py, ...  
  skills/         ← /gt:* skill definitions (16 skills)  
  templates/      ← vault scaffold templates
```

## Updating

```
# after git pull or downloading a new zip:  
bash install.sh
```

Each version installs into its own subdirectory; newer versions do not conflict with older ones.

## Uninstalling

```
rm -rf ~/.claude/plugins/cache/golden-thread-plugin
```

Your vault and `~/.claude/vault-config.json` are unaffected.

# 3. First-time setup

## `/gt:gt-init` — Initialize the vault

Run once per machine. Claude will ask:

- 1. "Do you already have an Obsidian vault on this machine?"
  - Yes → provide the path. Golden Thread adds only missing files; existing notes are untouched.
  - No → choose a path (default: `~/Documents/Obsidian/GoldenThreadVault` ). Obsidian is optional — the vault is plain Markdown and works without it.
- 2. "What's your domain or team name?" — e.g. "Platform Engineering" or "My Team"

The script writes `~/.claude/vault-config.json` , scaffolds the vault, and installs **Core-rule enforcement hooks** into `~/.claude/settings.json` . Idempotent — safe to re-run.

For a vault that predates the Core-rule tier:

```
python3 $SCRIPTS/vault_init.py install-core-rules --vault ~/my-vault
```

NOTE

`CLAUDE.md` is read at session start. Rules added mid-session apply from the *next* session — that is not a bug; restart to pick them up.

## `/gt:gt-create` — Scaffold a new project

| INPUT              | NOTES                                               |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Slug               | Must match the folder name; lowercase, hyphens only |
| Title              | Human-readable name                                 |
| Domain             | Coarse grouping, e.g. "platform", "data"            |
| Topology           | Where the code lives — see §4                       |
| Sub-project parent | Optional; slug of the parent project                |
| Runbook            | Whether to scaffold <code>runbook.md</code>         |

After scaffolding, Claude fills `idea.md` from your description. `idea.md` is immutable once written — the traceable "why".

## `/gt:gt-ingest` — Import an existing project

Copies notes and memory files into the vault. Never moves or deletes originals.

### WIKILINK TRAP

Renaming files destroys `[[wikilink]]` graphs. Measure first:

```
grep -roh '\[[^]]*\]' --include='*.md' . | wc -l
```

Prefer keeping filenames. Never repoint links inside `Sources/`.

## 4. Vault layout

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```
<vault>/
  CLAUDE.md          Conventions and page schema
  index.md           Navigational index of all Knowledge pages
  log.md             Append-only audit trail
  review-queue.md    Items flagged for owner review
  lint-declines.md   Suppressions with reasons

  Sources/           IMMUTABLE – never modified after creation
  Knowledge/         Cross-project wiki pages
  global-memory/     Loaded into every session
    MEMORY.md        Index – what actually gets read at session start

  Projects/
    CONVENTIONS.md   Stages, properties, domain taxonomy
    PROTOCOL.md      Cross-project process rules
    INFRASTRUCTURE.md Server fleet – defined ONCE, linked from projects

<slug>/
  README.md          Status board + YAML frontmatter
  source.md          Where the code lives; deploy topology
  idea.md            Origin story – IMMUTABLE
  research.md        Append-only dated findings
  decisions.md       Append-only numbered ADRs
  design.md          Current architecture – rewritten in place
  spec.md            Handoff artifact (when design complete)
  runbook.md         Operational procedures (optional)
  memory/
    MEMORY.md        Index – the ONLY file gt-open reads
  <topic>.md         Loaded on demand
```

## Project folder anatomy

| FILE                      | MUTABILITY          | PURPOSE                                              |
|---------------------------|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>idea.md</code>      | Immutable           | The "why" — never changed after creation             |
| <code>source.md</code>    | Updated             | Code location, deploy topology, file plan            |
| <code>research.md</code>  | Append-only         | Dated findings and gotchas                           |
| <code>decisions.md</code> | Append-only         | Numbered ADRs                                        |
| <code>design.md</code>    | Rewritten           | Current architecture — always describes NOW          |
| <code>spec.md</code>      | Created once        | Handoff artifact with acceptance criteria            |
| <code>runbook.md</code>   | Append / update     | Operational procedures and landmines                 |
| <code>memory/*.md</code>  | Updated per session | Session state; carries level/enforcement frontmatter |

## Source topology

| TOPOLOGY                    | MEANING                                         |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| <code>local</code>          | Folder on this machine. No deploy step.         |
| <code>remote</code>         | One repo, one server. Server pulls from GitHub. |
| <code>bastion-jump</code>   | Several servers via one gateway host.           |
| <code>bastion-direct</code> | Several servers, each independently reachable.  |

Bastion topologies carry a **file plan**: each deployed file is marked *static* (byte-identical everywhere) or *unique* (per-server; never cross-deployed). The fleet is defined once in `Projects/INFRASTRUCTURE.md` — never copied into a project file.

## 5. Daily workflow

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```
/gt:gt-open my-project    # load context, see where you left off

# ... work happens ...

/gt:gt-route              # drifted? where does this belong, and am I in the right

/gt:gt-work               # write back findings before closing
```

### `/gt:gt-open <slug>` — Start a session

Reads CONVENTIONS.md and PROTOCOL.md once per session, then the project in order:

```
source.md → idea.md → research.md → decisions.md
          → design.md → spec.md → runbook.md
          → INFRASTRUCTURE.md (bastion topologies)
          → memory/MEMORY.md    # index only; files load on demand
```

If `research.md` exceeds ~200 lines, reads headings first and only loads targeted sections. Announces the review-queue item count if non-zero. Summarises stage, topology, hosts, next action, blockers, and which memory files exist but are unloaded.

### `/gt:gt-route` — The middle of a session

`gt-open` runs before the session knows what it is; `gt-work` runs after it is over. Between them sits the part where the work actually changes shape, and nothing served it.

It reads only the conversation already in context — never project files, because reading `research.md` to decide where a note goes costs more than the note — and answers four things: what this has become (naming the drift explicitly), where the output belongs, whether the project, harness and model are right, and one next action. It writes nothing except a single `INBOX.md` line.

**"Nothing, keep going" is a designed-for answer.** A check that always finds work is a check nobody runs twice. Reach for it when a session opened as one thing and became another, when a finding may belong to a project other than the one loaded, or when you cannot name what you are doing. Being wrong costs one re-run.

## `/gt:gt-work` — End a session

The step most people skip — and skipping it is what causes the vault to decay.

| DESTINATION               | WHAT BELONGS THERE                                                        |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>research.md</code>  | New findings, dated. New discoveries only.                                |
| <code>decisions.md</code> | Numbered ADR with context and rejected alternatives. Stable choices only. |
| <code>design.md</code>    | Rewritten in place when architecture changed. Describes <i>now</i> .      |
| <code>runbook.md</code>   | Operational commands and known landmines.                                 |
| <code>memory/*.md</code>  | Session state, updated in place.                                          |
| <code>spec.md</code>      | Created when design is complete enough to hand off.                       |

Memory files carry frontmatter to make durability explicit:

```
metadata:
  type: core | feedback | user | reference
  level: core | context | generic      # default: generic
  enforcement: validated | reminder    # required only for level: core
```

Default to `generic`. Do **not** set `level: core` in `gt-work` — Core is a promotion that requires wiring a hook, which is `gt-promote`'s job.

After writing, `gt-work` asks whether any finding applies beyond this project and should be promoted. It also updates `stage:`, `topology:`, and `domain:` in `README.md` frontmatter when the project's reality changes.

## `/gt:gt-query` — Ask the vault a question

Reads `index.md`, follows wikilinks 2–3 hops into `Knowledge/`, falls back to `grep`. Be specific. If a result shows `status: stale`, verify it before acting.

# 6. Context & verification

## `/gt-farm:gt-farm` — Route work to external AI

Routes bulk, mechanical, or second-opinion tasks *out* of this context to an external AI service. The unit is a **work packet**: a self-contained Markdown document with a strict `FINDINGS / GAPS` return contract. Transport is swappable — paste into a web UI today; a script sends it to an API later. The packet is identical either way.

All four gates must pass before a task leaves. Any failure means the work stays here.

| GATE           | QUESTION                                 |
|----------------|------------------------------------------|
| Stateless      | Answerable with no vault or repo state?  |
| Self-contained | Fits in a paragraph plus a list of URLs? |
| Checkable      | Verifiable without redoing the work?     |
| Releasable     | Every input safe to hand a third party?  |

### RELEASABLE IS DEFAULT-DENY

Never include: account identifiers, balances, hostnames, internal IPs, credential locations, non-public source code, or personal identifiers. Check this gate while *building* the packet, not before sending it.

Key rules:

- One packet, one task. A packet asking three questions returns three half-answers.
- Supply a vocabulary block with exact model IDs and product names read from the system — never from memory. A stale prior produces a stale query.
- Results come back as `unverified` . Promote only after opening the `source:` URL and confirming the claim.
- `GAPS` is mandatory; `GAPS: None` must be justified, not asserted.
- Cite the specific page carrying the claim — never a homepage or section index.

Packets are saved to `<vault>/Projects/external-ai-tools/packets/YYYY-MM-DD-slug.md` for auditability.

## `/gt:gt-validate` — Verify claims by re-deriving

Verifies a claim by **re-deriving** it, not by reviewing the reasoning that produced it. Give a validator your reasoning and it grades the argument — and inherits the same blind spot. Give it only the claim, the rules, and the artifact, and it must go back to primary sources.

Use before recording a finding as fact, before a production change, or when a number matters.

### VALIDATOR CLASSES

| CLASS                        | USE WHEN                                                                  |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>empirical</code>       | A number, measurement, or result could be wrong                           |
| <code>vantage</code>         | The measurement position may not be able to observe the answer            |
| <code>rule-compliance</code> | Work must satisfy <code>core-rules/</code> or <code>CONVENTIONS.md</code> |
| <code>code</code>            | Code may not do what its name, comment, or docs claim                     |

Build the packet with exactly three fields: `claim` , `rules` , `artifact` . Strip all conclusions, confidence signals, and adjectives that imply the expected answer. If it says "confirm that X", rewrite it as "determine whether X".

Outcomes: **confirmed** / **refuted** / **cannot-verify**. `cannot-verify` is never a pass — name what was missing. Append the verdict to `research.md` . A refutation supersedes the original finding.

# 7. Knowledge management

## `/gt:gt-promote` — Graduate a finding

The judgement call: has a second project proved this general?

| FROM → TO                                                | WHEN                                                                            |
|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>memory/</code> → <code>research / decisions</code> | Finding stopped changing session to session                                     |
| <code>project</code> → <code>Knowledge/</code>           | A second project hit the same truth                                             |
| <code>Knowledge/</code> → <code>global-memory/</code>    | Needed in every session, every project                                          |
| <code>any</code> → Core tier                             | Rule must be enforced, not just stored — <code>gt-promote</code> wires the hook |

Nothing is deleted. Retiring sets `status: stale` and records the superseding fact.

## `/gt:gt-refresh` — Update sources

Checks `Sources/` for upstream changes. Creates a new immutable file with `supersedes:` — never edits the old one. Knowledge pages citing the old source are flagged for update.

## Where does this fact go?

| THE FACT                                   | GOES TO                        |
|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| "This preset is wrong right now"           | <code>memory/</code>           |
| "This API rejects plural keys"             | <code>research.md</code>       |
| "We use POST for all mutations, and why"   | <code>decisions.md</code>      |
| "The system is structured like this now"   | <code>design.md</code>         |
| "This platform behaviour bit two projects" | <code>Knowledge/</code>        |
| "Always diff before overwriting prod"      | <code>global-memory/</code>    |
| "How to restart the prod backtest"         | <code>runbook.md</code>        |
| "Never scp without backing up"             | <code>PROTOCOL.md</code>       |
| "This code lives on host X at path Y"      | <code>source.md</code>         |
| "Which box serves which role"              | <code>INFRASTRUCTURE.md</code> |

### TWO FAILURE MODES

**Too narrow:** a platform truth buried in one project — the next project rediscovers it the hard way.

**Too wide:** a quirk in `global-memory/` loading into unrelated sessions as a rule that isn't true there.

When unsure, file narrow. Promotion is cheap; demotion isn't.

# 8. Maintenance

`/gt:gt-lint` — Health checks

| CHECK                            | WHAT IT CATCHES                                                                     |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>index-gap</code>           | Knowledge page not in <code>index.md</code> — <code>gt-query</code> won't find it   |
| <code>broken-link</code>         | <code>[[wikilink]]</code> resolving to nothing                                      |
| <code>orphan</code>              | Knowledge page linked from nowhere                                                  |
| <code>memory-unlisted</code>     | <code>memory/*.md</code> not in <code>MEMORY.md</code> — Claude will never load it  |
| <code>global-gap</code>          | <code>global-memory/*.md</code> not in its index                                    |
| <code>memory-bloat</code>        | <code>global-memory/</code> file over 30 lines                                      |
| <code>global-scope-leak</code>   | Project-specific content in <code>global-memory/</code>                             |
| <code>superseded-cited</code>    | Knowledge page citing a superseded source                                           |
| <code>stale</code>               | Knowledge page marked <code>status: stale</code>                                    |
| <code>source-todo</code>         | <code>source.md</code> with no topology or deployment targets                       |
| <code>frontmatter</code>         | Project README missing properties, or slug $\neq$ folder name                       |
| <code>core-misplaced</code>      | A rule declares <code>level: core</code> but lives outside <code>core-rules/</code> |
| <code>core-no-enforcement</code> | <code>level: core</code> with no <code>enforcement</code> field declared            |
| <code>core-unenforced</code>     | The declared enforcement hook is not actually wired                                 |

**NEVER SUPPRESS CORE-UNENFORCED**

This is the machine-checkable form of "rule stored but never asserted". Suppressing it recreates the original bug with a paper trail saying it was fine.

Fix: `vault_init.py install-core-rules --vault <vault>`

TRIAGE WORKFLOW

1. **You broke it** — fix now
2. **Already broken** — record in `review-queue.md` ; don't guess at a target
3. **False positive** — suppress in `lint-declines.md` with the reason

## `/gt:gt-settings` — Automatic behaviour

View and toggle everything Golden Thread does without being asked.

| SETTING                        | VALUES                                                                            | DEFAULT              | WHAT IT DOES                                                                                                  |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>component_updates</code> | <code>off</code> · <code>report</code> · <code>confirm</code> · <code>auto</code> | <code>report</code>  | At session start, compares installed hooks/scripts against plugin source and reports drift                    |
| <code>report_card</code>       | <code>off</code> · <code>minimal</code> · <code>full</code>                       | <code>minimal</code> | At <code>/compact</code> , summarises session hygiene                                                         |
| <code>watch</code>             | <code>off</code> · <code>report</code>                                            | <code>off</code>     | Hourly repo-watch fetch and the session-start report                                                          |
| <code>install_demo</code>      | <code>yes</code> · <code>no</code>                                                | <code>yes</code>     | Whether <code>install.sh</code> installs <code>/gt-demo:gt-demo</code> , its script and the PizzaBot template |

```
python3 $SCRIPTS/gt_settings.py show           # current state
python3 $SCRIPTS/gt_settings.py explain <name> # reasoning behind the default
python3 $SCRIPTS/gt_settings.py set <name> <value>
```

## `/gt:gt-runbook-lint` and `/gt:gt-review`

**gt-runbook-lint** finds procedures duplicated across runbooks and routes them to the right shared layer: `PROTOCOL.md` , a Knowledge page, or a repo `CLAUDE.md` .

**gt-review** scans Obsidian daily notes for uncaptured tasks and ideas, then promotes selected ones into tracked projects.

## `/gt-watch:gt-watch` — Upstream repo watch

A watch is a vault note ( `Projects/golden-thread/watches/<slug>.md` ) naming a git URL and what to care about. `gt_watch.py fetch` , run from cron without Claude, asks the remote what changed ( `git ls-remote` plus a shallow fetch; `gh` only for releases and advisories), classifies each change as **p0**, **review** or **routine** by fixed rules, and appends it to `~/ .claude/golden-thread/watch/events.jsonl` . A SessionStart hook reads that queue — never the network — and

reports unacknowledged changes, P0 first. Each state file has one writer: the fetch owns `state.json` and `events.jsonl`, the skill owns only the `acked.json` cursor. Setting `watch`, default `off`.

P0 means: a new security advisory; a tag or release naming a CVE/GHSA id or announcing a security fix; a commit carrying a CVE/GHSA id; a `SECURITY.md` or watched-path change saying the same; or a watch's own `p0_when` pattern. Bare words like "auth" never are.

## `/gt-demo:gt-demo` — Guided tour

Module `demo` (plugin `gt-demo`). A tour on PizzaBot 3000 — nine core acts plus one from each installed module that ships one (wiki, watch, flow) — run in its own throwaway vault at `~/.claude/golden-thread/demo-vault`. `start` builds it and prints the pinned launch command (`GT_VAULT=<demo vault> GT_WATCH=report GT_WATCH_STATE=... claude`); in that session `tour` performs each act with the real skill and waits on a Next button; `end` lists what the tour produced; `clean` rebuilds the vault; `remove` deletes it; `bash install.sh --without demo` removes the module.

## `/gt-flow:gt-flow` — Flow view

Module `flow` (plugin `gt-flow`), new in 0.15.0. Renders the vault's `events.jsonl` as one self-contained HTML file that opens offline: a lane per project, time left to right, an arrow each time an item climbed a level. Add `--redact` before the page leaves your screen; task events are hidden until clicked or `--tasks`. A vault older than the events recovers its history with `gt_events.py --vault <vault> backfill --dry-run`.

The acts live in `templates/demo-pizzabot/tour.md`, one section each with `narration:`, `do:` and `point:` lines. The demo never writes `vault-config.json` — every skill and hook honors `$GT_VAULT` — and `clean / remove` delete only a directory carrying the demo's marker file.

## 9. Knowledge wiki (gt-wiki)

The `gt-wiki` plugin adds a structured knowledge base with immutable sources. Every ingested document is stored verbatim in `Sources/` and never modified. Knowledge pages are synthesized summaries that link back to the originals.

### Setup and usage

```
/gt:gt-wiki-init           # initialize
/gt:gt-wiki-ingest <url or file path> # add a source
/gt:gt-wiki                # query
/gt:gt-wiki-lint           # health check
/gt:gt-wiki-refresh        # check sources for upstream changes
```

### Deterministic helpers

Two stdlib scripts in `golden-thread-wiki/<ver>/scripts/` take the mechanical parts out of the LLM's hands:

- **wiki\_log.py** — the only writer of `log.md` and `index.md` entries. `log` appends `## [YYYY-MM-DD] <op> | <title>` from a closed vocabulary (ingest, query, lint, refresh, graduate, retire, relocate); `index` adds a page entry under a section, or replaces an existing one in place.
- **wiki\_refresh.py** — report-only change detection. For a source with `local:` it runs `git fetch` and `git diff base..head`, where `base` is the source's `upstream_sha:` or the last commit on or before its `ingested:` date. Web-only sources are listed as `fetch-needed`. Exit 0 = nothing changed, 1 = changes found, 2 = error.

## Page format

```
---
title: Page Title
category: concept | tool | runbook | decision | reference
tags:
  - lowercase-hyphenated
sources:
  - "[[Sources/filename.md]]"
created: YYYY-MM-DD
updated: YYYY-MM-DD
status: seed | growing | mature | stale
---
```

### CROSS-LINKS ARE THE NAVIGATION LAYER

Claude follows `[[wikilinks]]` hop by hop from `index.md` . Link bidirectionally. Cross-domain links (A ↔ B from different areas) are the most commonly missed and the most valuable for multi-hop questions.

## 10. Script reference

---

```
SCRIPTS=~/.claude/plugins/cache/golden-thread-plugin/gt/0.11.0/scripts
```

### **vault\_init.py**

```
# Fresh vault
python3 $SCRIPTS/vault_init.py fresh \
  --vault ~/my-vault --domain "My Team"

# Create a project
python3 $SCRIPTS/vault_init.py create-project \
  --vault ~/my-vault \
  --name my-project --title "My Project" \
  --tags "backend,api" --domain platform \
  --topology bastion-direct --runbook

# Create a sub-project
python3 $SCRIPTS/vault_init.py create-project \
  --vault ~/my-vault --name sub-feature \
  --parent my-project --domain platform

# Connect an existing vault to a new machine
python3 $SCRIPTS/vault_init.py connect --vault ~/existing-vault

# Install Core-rule enforcement hooks (for older vaults)
python3 $SCRIPTS/vault_init.py install-core-rules --vault ~/my-vault
```

### **gt\_ingest.py**

```
python3 $SCRIPTS/gt_ingest.py ~/Projects/my-project --json
```

## gt\_lint.py

```
python3 $SCRIPTS/gt_lint.py ~/my-vault \  
--queue ~/my-vault/review-queue.md
```

## gt\_settings.py

```
python3 $SCRIPTS/gt_settings.py show  
python3 $SCRIPTS/gt_settings.py explain component_updates  
python3 $SCRIPTS/gt_settings.py set report_card off
```

# 11. Troubleshooting

| SYMPTOM                                                   | CAUSE & FIX                                                                                                                                          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "vault-config.json not found"                             | Run <code>/gt:gt-init</code>                                                                                                                         |
| Skills not showing after install                          | Restart Claude Code. Skills register at startup only.                                                                                                |
| A rule in <code>CLAUDE.md</code> is ignored               | Read at session start only. Rules added mid-session apply next session. Run <code>/hooks</code> or restart.                                          |
| Memory files aren't loading                               | By design — <code>gt-open</code> loads on demand. Ask for the file by name.                                                                          |
| A memory file is never offered                            | Run <code>/gt:gt-lint</code> — likely <code>memory-unlisted</code> .                                                                                 |
| <code>gt-query</code> can't find a page you added         | Likely <code>index-gap</code> . Add the page to <code>index.md</code> .                                                                              |
| Core rules apply inconsistently                           | Run <code>/gt:gt-lint</code> and look for <code>core-unenforced</code> . Fix:<br><code>vault_init.py install-core-rules --vault &lt;vault&gt;</code> |
| Timestamp missing from responses                          | Enforcement hook unwired. Run <code>/hooks</code> or re-run <code>install.sh</code> .                                                                |
| Want to turn off the session report                       | Run <code>/gt:gt-settings set report_card off</code>                                                                                                 |
| Lint suppression isn't working                            | Paths are matched case-insensitively. Use the path exactly as lint reports it.                                                                       |
| "conflict: vault-config.json points to a different vault" | Run <code>vault_init.py connect --vault &lt;new-path&gt;</code>                                                                                      |